

The Boston Globe

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Healey says she'll seek reelection next year

By Matt Stout
GLOBE STAFF

Governor Maura Healey, who rose to political prominence as a fierce critic of Donald Trump and made history as the first woman elected Massachusetts governor, said Friday that she intends to run for reelection next year, making her the first candidate to publicly declare for the race.

Healey, a first-term Democrat, made the announcement during her monthly appearance on GBH's "Boston Public Radio," cementing her plans over 20 months ahead of the 2026 election.

Her reelection campaign will play out amid a rapidly shifting political environment, with Healey trying to govern a blue state at a time when Trump has returned to the White House. Democrats are still navigating how to respond to him and the onslaught of policy changes his new administration is seeking.

Healey indicated her decision was motivated by a desire to complete the work she has pledged to tackle as governor. She said Friday that she and her lieutenant governor, Kim Driscoll, vowed early on in her tenure to "get after" improvements in a number of areas during their first term, naming housing, transportation, and education specifically. She also cited her pledge to cut taxes; Healey signed a tax relief bill in 2023.

"I feel like we've done all those things, and

HEALEY, Page A10

BPS pressed to do something more with its empty schools

By Christopher Huffaker
GLOBE STAFF

If history is any guide, schools shut under a recently proposed wave of Boston Public Schools closures will likely simply become other schools.

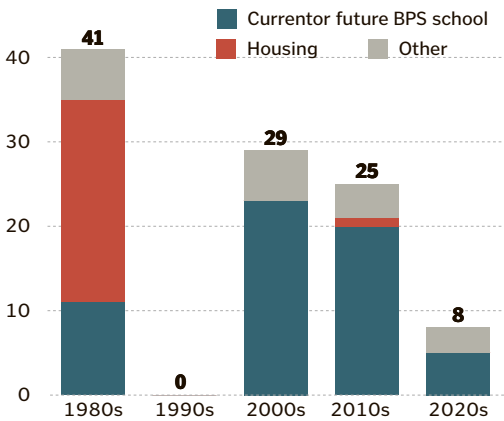
Since 1980, more than 100 district schools have closed, according to a Globe analysis of noncomprehensive BPS data. However, despite decades of declining enrollment, the majority remain BPS schools or are slated to become one again. Overall, there are about 60 current and former schools on closed school grounds — versus about 25 that have been turned into housing.

Some city leaders, including City Council President Ruthzee Louijeune, want the city to make use of more former school buildings for projects such as the Pryde, an affordable apartment building for LGBTQ+ seniors that opened last year in Hyde Park's former Rogers Middle School. Louijeune plans to file legislation that would make affordable housing the default option for surplus district buildings, by giving the Mayor's Office of Housing the

SCHOOLS, Page A10

BPS building closure conversions

Based on a Globe analysis of non-comprehensive district data on school closures, not building closures. Other uses include non-BPS schools, offices, and other government buildings. Some buildings have gone through multiple school closures.



SOURCE: Boston Public Schools data, Globe research
CHRISTOPHER HUFFAKER/GLOBE STAFF

Massachusetts General Hospital successfully completed its second transplant of a genetically edited pig kidney, the world's fourth. **B1.**

Employers added 143,000 jobs in January, slightly less than expected, but with revisions and a decline in the unemployment rate, American workers still appear to be in good shape. **D1.**

A federal judge in Boston grilled the Justice Department about its claim that President Trump has the authority to end birthright citizenship. **B1.**

Security officials in the United Kingdom have demanded that Apple create a back door allowing them to retrieve all content any Apple user worldwide has uploaded to the cloud. **A5.**

The US government will now only recognize two sexes, male and female.

The State Department no longer issues passports with gender markers consistent with transgender people's identity.

Government agencies deleted the T for transgender from web pages, which now say LGB.

The Census Bureau and CDC removed information on sexual orientation and gender identity.

'Like he's simply trying to erase trans existence'



LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF

Vanessa Ford, mother of a transgender teen (background), worries about what has happened and what's ahead.

Speed, breadth of Trump's orders shock a community that has made strides

By Mike Damiano
GLOBE STAFF

President Trump's orders on transgender issues cover a range of subjects: passports, sports, military service, and medicine.

But to many transgender people, they all boil down to a single message: You no longer exist.

"It's just basically: *We're erasing everything that you are*," said Vanessa Ford, a mother of a transgender teen from the North Shore.

Trump has signed executive orders seeking to bar trans-

gender people from the military, halt the practice of transgender medicine for minors, prohibit schools from acknowledging a child's transgender identity, and ban transgender women from women's sports.

And in his most sweeping statement, Trump declared it is "the policy of the United States to recognize two sexes, male and female" and asserted these "sexes are not changeable and are grounded in fundamental and incontrovertible reality."

Now the federal bureaucracy is implementing his vision.

The State Department stopped issuing passports with gen-

TRANS, Page A6

ICE pushes harder, Mass. pushes back

By Sean Cotter
GLOBE STAFF

For years, federal immigration authorities have waged wars of words with Boston and other so-called sanctuary cities that limit cooperation with federal immigration officials. But President Trump's Justice Department dramatically escalated its opposition last week, threatening to prosecute authorities in Ithaca, N.Y., who did not hold a Mexican man who'd pleaded guilty to an assault charge.

At the time, Trump's acting deputy attorney general, Emil Bove, vowed to "use every tool at our disposal" to counteract rules that prohibit cooperation with US Immigration and Customs Enforcement. And the statement about the man's arrest closed on an ominous note: "The US Attorney's Office for the Northern District of New York is looking into the circumstances surrounding his release."

Trump swept into office promising aggressive immigration enforcement and mass deportations that ICE does not have the means to car-

ICE, Page A7



Trump blocked for now on USAID

A federal judge said he would order a temporary halt to plans to pull thousands of staffers off the job, even as workers removed signs on the agency's headquarters. **A2.**

Effect on Gaza

The effort to downsize USAID has endangered the funding for food, tents, and medical treatment for hundreds of thousands of Palestinians. **A4.**

In crosshairs, federal workers flock to unions

By Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — In their aggressive bid to upend the federal government, Elon Musk and his lieutenants have, perhaps unintentionally, driven thousands of federal workers into the arms of one of the biggest enemies of their sweeping project.

Organized labor.

Unions that represent federal government workers are reporting significant increases in signups since President Trump took office and empowered Musk's "Department of Government Efficiency" to drastically slash the federal workforce.

The American Federation of Government Employees, the largest union representing federal workers, added 5,575 new members in the first six days of February alone, according to union spokesperson Tim Kaufman. By comparison, the union gained 14,996 new members during all of 2024.

Currently, AFGE has 319,233 active mem-

UNIONS, Page A7

Take it to the banks

Saturday: Snow late. High 33-38. Low 25-30.

Sunday: Storm wraps up. High 28-33. Low 16-21.

Sunrise: 6:50 Sunset: 5:08

Weather and Comics, D4-5.

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